towards the university, I was suddenly stopped by the Berlin Wall at the Brandenburg Gate. Walking along the Wall, it occurred to me that the vibration I had felt earlier might be energy that had been trapped within the city. … The air felt electric."[8]

Between teaching spurts, this experience by the Wall beckoned him to embark on a new artistic undertaking. He set out to photograph the Wall in its entirety as a study in sculpture, focusing on the portion coursing through the middle of the city, from its southernmost point to its northern edge. Over a six-month period, he photographed in West Berlin after school or during his commute back to Baarlo, driving to a location, surveying the landscape, and shooting multiple frames. He eventually produced over 550 sequential negatives. While his goal was to grasp the sweeping, routine nature of the border wall system, he grappled with moments of variation, due in part to the Wall's unwieldy path and his own desire to track particularly curious attributes or angles. In addition to viewing densely populated urban areas and checkpoints with border guards then familiar to global audiences, he located the Wall on the city's margins: coursing through fields, cutting off access to bridges, jumping back and forth across waterways, and running into ruined buildings swallowed by the Wall's path. In the artist's view, the Wall constituted an evolving construction site and an embedded piece of architecture within a city steadily accustomed to its own division.

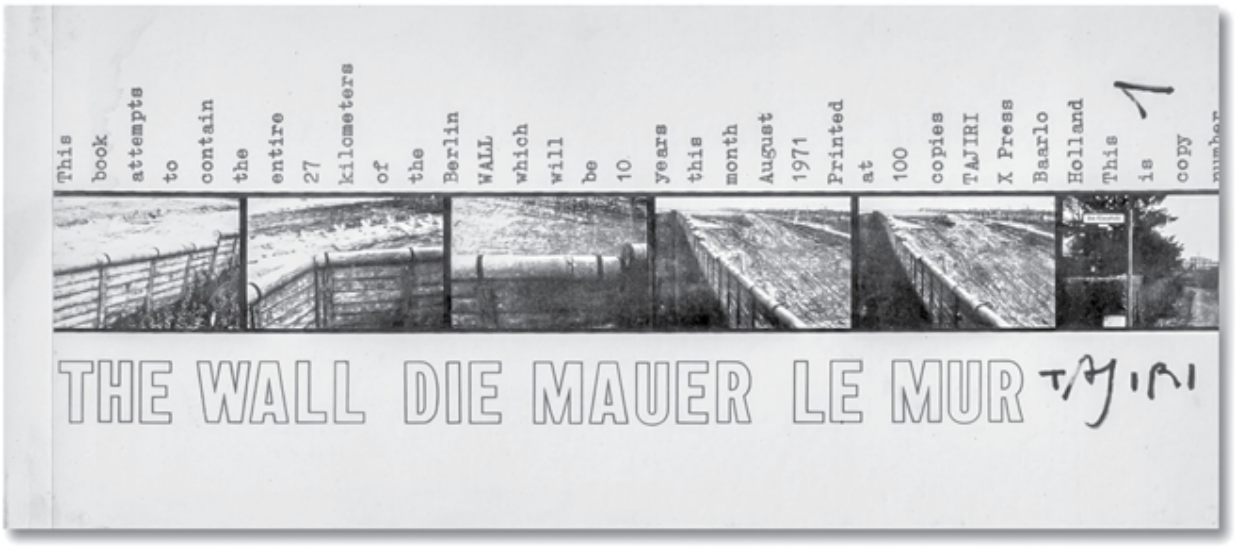


FIGURE 3.2 Shinkichi Tajiri, *The Wall Die Mauer Le Mur*, 1971. (Shinkichi Tajiri Estate)